PASCOINKCAEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we're here at the fabulous show called Muppet and it's in Cannes in France and I have with me Vasco Santos and Vasco Santos is the global head of leasing for Inca Centre. This is INGKA Centre Services. They're based in Malmo, Sweden.

Now if you have been to a shopping centre in Europe, in UK, Europe itself, Scandinavia, India, China, all over the world you have probably visited an INGKA Centre and not even realized it. Vasco, welcome to the program. Welcome, thank you.

Thank you so much for welcoming me. This shopping centre empire, it's part of the IKEA group and it's a separate empire to IKEA. It's its own entity.

Can you tell us a bit about how it all works? So INGKA Centre is part of INGKA group and the INGKA group owns the majority of the IKEA stores around the world. We're talking about more than 400 stores and INGKA group has three different companies. One is IKEA retail, so the stores that you know very well.

Then there is INGKA Centre where we develop mixed-use projects around the world, always retail-led and always anchored by an IKEA store and then we have also INGKA investments that as the name says investments in many areas forestry, renewable energy and other business areas. So these three elements are part of INGKA group and yes so I'm part of INGKA Centre, the real estate company. Well I've been looking at your figures and stats and you have multi multi million people running through your properties and stores every year.

It's a really popular system that you have. Yes, you absolutely right. So we are in North America, we are in Europe as you mentioned before and we are in China and we are now also developing amazing projects, also mixed-use projects in India and so across all these geographies, yes we welcome every year 335 million people that are attracted by the mix of retail stores, F&B, leisure entertainment and of course IKEA store which is a major attractive point of our shopping centres.

And another one of flagship customers is H&M which are in a Swedish company which is in many many of your centres. Absolutely, H&M is one of one of our main partners, they have been with us in many years in many locations. I think they are almost everywhere with us but not only of course H&M but also Zara that you know very well and you know Uniqlo that so in the fashion category right but other brands but yes H&M we share the same Scandinavian heritage so it's definitely a partner that we cherish very much.

And entertainment is very popular and very important for shopping centres isn't it and I suppose you liaise with all the entertainment providers too to make it a fabulous visiting experience. Correct, I think Covid showed that people really want to interact in a physical space, people are really looking to have this sense of belonging, the sense of community and to have a public realm where they can really express themselves and feel they are part of a community. So what you've

seen after Covid across the world and this is not specific to one look at one geography across the world is people they came back strongly to these spaces and of course they are looking for much more than just transactional shopping.

As it said I mean they're looking to have places where you can spend good time with the family with friends so leisure and entertainment facilities have been growing in our portfolio but also F&B you know across the world we see the elevation of F&B experience in the shopping centre and we are putting that as a priority to offer an experience that goes beyond the transactional and besides that something that is very specifically in consensus and I'm sure that your audience will relate to if visit one of our shopping centres what we call meeting places and we don't call them shopping centres exactly because they go beyond shopping is that we become a place for the community we have a very broad programming interacting with communities we welcome everyone you know every group specific group of people that have a hobby of a certain interest to like reading clubs or poetry clubs or whatever we give our space for them right so that's also something that we we like people to feel like this is their place as well how did you get into this fast go I know you're Portuguese and it's a Swedish company and how did it all happen for you yeah thank you for asking that yes in fact I started in retail business 30 years ago I started with the French sports retail Decathlon which is a worldwide retailer so I spent 10 years of my time on the retail side and then came to the other side of the table if I if I can say so to be on on the real estate side but dealing every day with retailers so I've been in the company doing the commercial part you know the leasing job then I was doing a hazard management asset management and since seven years ago I took the the global role so I I'm leading the leasing team across the globe for foreign consensus which is I think is the best job in the world the having the chance to work with things in China in India us Europe exposed to these multicultural environments and working with amazing people that deal every day with the thousands of different partners and doing partnerships that at the end of the day will deliver a great experience for our customers and also you get to be in the head office in Sweden in Malmo which is fantastic and it's a it's a great place to be Sweden and so many innovations come out of Sweden including your company IKEA and so many more. Yeah Sweden is known although it's not a very big country in terms of population right but Sweden is known for being strong at innovation and yeah there are many examples and you know and IKEA has been really leading that home furnishing and innovation throughout the years yeah Sweden is a great country is a country that has a culture that we are very much appreciate very much in terms of all the values that represents we bring this Swedishness everywhere we go you can fill it in not only in the IKEA store because you know our shopping centers will bring Scandinavian design we bring you know a lot of the Swedishness to any different countries so it's with pride of course. Well Vasco thank you so much for being with us here on travel radio Australia it's been fascinating catching up with you and as I say look out for the logo the Inca logo that's INGKA centers across the world when you are traveling and thank you for your time.

Thank you Jeff thank you very much.